Appendix 2 Criteria for assessing the level of evidence of included publications

Level of Evidence	Description
I	Systematic review of level II studies
II	Randomized controlled trial (RCT)
III-1	A pseudo-RCT (alternate allocation of some other method)
III-2	A comparative study with concurrent controls; non-randomized experimental trial; cohort study, case-control study; interrupted time series with a control group
III-3	A comparative study without concurrent controls; historical control study; two or more single arm studies
IV	Case series with either pre-test / post-test outcomes